

# ChatGPT attacks the spine (v1.1), step 3

Received 2026-08-30, verbatim except that em dashes are normalised to colons per the house rule.

Attachment was the v1.1 spine pdf only. Disposition per finding is in the status table; repairs are in spine v1.2.

## Status

| #  | Finding                                                                                           | Status                                | Repair (v1.2)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Liam saw the brush on Day 2, so the decoy is exposed on Day 19                                    | <b>Accepted, fatal to the brush</b>   | Decoy changed: the boat name board from her hall, taken by Brad on Day 0 from the one place none of the four had been in the 19 days. The brush stays character texture and is tested and failed in D1 only                                                                                                                                                |
| 2  | Days 53 and 214 are Fridays, not Sundays                                                          | <b>Accepted</b>                       | Weekday labels corrected; Brad travels Friday night to the Saturday 05:47 on both journeys; Tessa's alarm moves to Sunday Day 216 when Margo does not arrive                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 3  | Under R22 Del's first action on Ruby's Day 27 letters is examination                              | <b>Accepted</b>                       | Rows 25, 30 and C4 rewritten: examination runs, returns consistent, nothing follows, and the room learns the letter carries a police stamp                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 4  | Two MP files at one flat revive the lodger file and an activity check reaches the renewed licence | <b>Accepted, the dangerous one</b>    | The lodger lived aboard the skipper's boat and kept a bag at Brad's; the file names the boat, never Brad. No document carries Brad's face: no licence renewal, no bank; the name is inert on every register from Day -1090. R26's licence sentence withdrawn (it was Claude's detail, not the ruling)                                                      |
| 5  | A proper review canvasses the cage and finds the fishmonger                                       | <b>Contested</b>                      | The detective visits the cage on Day 226 and asks about access; the question that reaches the fishmonger's memory (which of the four came before Saturday) requires a swap hypothesis nobody alive holds; authorship is examined and consistent, and the survivors dispute the reading not the origin. Written into C7 as a judgement, flagged for Stephen |
| 6  | The pub saw Brad and the deckhand together                                                        | <b>Accepted by GPT's own wrong-if</b> | The drinking was at Brad's flat; the pub is removed as a holder                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 7  | The panel is removable to Brad but not damning to the three                                       | <b>Answered from the lodger</b>       | The panel is signwriter's work and only one of the four is a signwriter. Violet's letter argued quality; the three would not. Stated in D1                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 8  | Margo to Del on Day 44 does not "fail"; the contradiction stays open                              | <b>Accepted</b>                       | C5 rewritten: allegation recorded, examination consistent, contradiction referred and not evidence of an act, all four interviewed, Brad alerted, the room knows                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 9  | Layouts are not her private hand; capability leaves residue                                       | <b>Accepted</b>                       | Brad holds the debt book from Day 0 (pages of her cursive) and practised her hand privately for years on Tuesday nights, burned each time, under the finding-2 ruling that he secretly has the talent. Residue rows added                                                                                                                                  |
| 10 | No. 14's sighting comes out at the door-knock                                                     | <b>Accepted</b>                       | No. 14 reports a man in the lane at 22:30 carrying a flat thing under his arm; noted, unidentified; on Day 222 it is re-read against Liam, who held a key. A listener later notes the build is wrong for Liam                                                                                                                                              |

## The response, verbatim

### Verdict: REWORK

1. **B3 row 31 / D2: Day 19: Liam. Confidence: 100%.** Liam saw the brush in Violet's unit on Day 2, after her death, so he knows Violet could not have placed it in the cage; he tells the room immediately, the decoy

is exposed, and the reading cannot survive until Day 44.

*Wrong if:* Liam did not see or cannot identify that specific brush on Day 2.

1. **A4 / C9: Days 53–54 and 214–215: Brad. Confidence: 100%.** With Day 0 fixed as Monday, Days 53–54 are Friday–Saturday and Days 214–215 are Friday–Saturday, not Sunday–Monday, so Brad cannot use the stated Sunday arrival and Monday 05:47 service on either journey.

*Wrong if:* Day 0 is not Monday, or the journey days and every dependent date are renumbered.

1. **B3 rows 25 and 30 / C4: Day 27: Ruby and Del. Confidence: 100%.** Ruby lawfully holds both posthumous letters and the confirmed yard fact; if she takes them to Del, R22 makes Del's first mandatory action document examination, not merely taking a statement and asking the coroner's officer, so the recipient column suppresses the earliest required response.

*Wrong if:* R22 excludes documents received before an investigation is formally reopened, contrary to its stated rule.

1. **B1 row 10a / B7 R6 / C7: Day 222: the assigned detective. Confidence: 99%.** The detective lawfully holds two missing-person files naming the same flat, takes that link to the missing-person supervisor, whose first mandatory action is to reassess the older file and check subsequent activity under the lodger's identity; that reaches the renewed licence carrying Brad's face before Ally begins.

*Wrong if:* Havenbay forbids identity-activity checks when changed facts revive a low-risk missing-person file, even after a second occupant of the same address disappears.

1. **B7 R1 / B3 row 27: Day 222: the assigned detective and the Bay 3 fishmonger. Confidence: 99%.** A proper review of letters allegedly recovered from Cage 4 requires the detective to inspect their stated origin and canvass adjacent holders; the fishmonger lawfully reports Brad's Day 16 visit, and the detective's first mandatory action is to take that statement and re-interview the cage holders about his access before Saturday.

*Wrong if:* Havenbay's proper review of a material posthumous document excludes examination of the place where it was allegedly found.

1. **B1 row 10a / C8: Day –1090: the pub witness and reporting constable. Confidence: 98%.** The pub is listed as holding the lodger node but is absent from the sweep; when the constable establishes the deckhand's last movements, the pub lawfully reports the night's drinking and Brad's presence, and the constable's first mandatory action is to record Brad as the last known companion and test his account again.

*Wrong if:* Nobody at the pub saw Brad and the deckhand together that night, in which case the pub should be removed as a holder from row 10a.

1. **D1 / B3 row 28: Day 19: Liam, Ruby and Margo. Confidence: 97%.** The panel's mark identifies Brad's second identity only to Brad, while the three innocents know neither that identity nor his hidden hand, so their pooled facts suggest exit preparations but never connect Brad to the panel; the object is removable to him but not damning to them.

*Wrong if:* One innocent already holds an independent fact connecting the maker's mark or concealed hand to Brad before the cage opens.

1. **B3 row 33 / C5: Day 44: Margo and Del. Confidence: 96%.** Margo lawfully holds her dated file note, Violet's direct account of the cash and a letter asserting a contradictory source; if she takes them to Del, Del must record the statement, preserve both documents, order the R22 examination and refer the factual contradiction to the coroner's officer, because "consistent handwriting" does not make the contradiction or forgery allegation fail.

*Wrong if:* Havenbay treats a handwriting finding of "consistent" as conclusive proof of authorship and bars consideration of contradictory contemporaneous evidence.

1. **D3 / B7 R2–R3: Day 17: Brad. Confidence: 94%.** Professional layouts and one personal sample do not demonstrate that Brad can compose a long, natural letter in Violet's private handwriting in one night and pass comparison against four genuine contemporaneous letters; acquiring that capability would leave prior practice, retained exemplars or Day 16–17 research that B7 does not price.

*Wrong if:* Brad's established seven-year work with Violet included sustained practice reproducing her ordinary handwriting, not merely her lettering and layouts.

1. **B2 row 18 / C8: Day 1: No. 14 and the door-knocking officer. Confidence: 92%.** No. 14 lawfully holds a sighting of a man leaving the back lane near the death window; the officer's mandatory door-knock includes movements and visitors, and the first required response is a witness statement followed by identifying Violet's likely last visitor, not limiting the question to when Violet was last seen.

*Wrong if:* No. 14 cannot place the sighting anywhere near Monday night or does not disclose it when asked about activity around the house.

R23 and R25 are reasonable rules: carrier and app records without a speculative tower dump, plus a car-park camera showing Margo arriving alone, constitute competent proportionate review. They do not suppress the cage canvass or the renewed missing-person duty.

The nineteen-mile legs do not independently break: Brad needs roughly 3.26 mph outbound and 3.0 mph returning, feasible for the established runner, although with little margin; the weekday contradiction is the actual clock failure.

The Day –75 leak is not a disguised outcome-producing coincidence: Brad has already chosen murder, and the leak creates Violet's opportunity to resist while making Brad's position worse.